Antonio Villani

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Education

PhD Candidate in Economics, Universitat Pompeu Fabra 2022–2027 (expected)
Advisors: Prof. Priit Jeenas and Prof. Jordi Galí

Master of Research in Economics, Finance and Management 2021–2022
(2nd year, PhD track), Universitat Pompeu Fabra

Master's Degree in Economics and Finance (1st year, PhD track), 2020–2021
Barcelona School of Economics

BA(Econ)(Hons) Economics and Philosophy, The University of Manchester 2017–2020
First Class Honours
Thesis: "A defence of Salmon's Neo-Russellianism" (philosophy of language and logic)

Research Fields

Macroeconomics, Financial Economics, Monetary Economics

References

Priit Jeenas
Assistant Professor
Universitat Pompeu Fabra

Jordi Galí
Senior Researcher
CREi

Jan Eeckhout
ICREA Research Professor
Universitat Pompeu Fabra

Dmitry Kuvshinov
Associate Professor
Universitat Pompeu Fabra

Job Market Paper

The Effects of Corporate Purchase Programmes on Market Power [Draft]

Does unconventional monetary policy affect the market power of firms? I address this question both empirically and theoretically. Comparing firms purchased under the European Central Bank's Corporate Sector Purchase Programme with eligible but unpurchased ones in a staggered difference-in-differences design, I show that a purchase raises a firm's markups by 7.1 percent. The transmission channel runs from issuing conditions to capital: purchased bonds are issued at a 22 basis point lower yield to maturity, and purchased firms invest 2.2 percentage points more. These effects materialise only under two conditions: purchases must be repeated over the years, and they must happen within a week of the bond issuance. A general equilibrium model rationalises these findings, combining endogenous markups and financial frictions. In a segmented bond market, a purchase raises the price of the very issue it absorbs, relaxes the issuer's capital constraint, and thus raises its output, market share and markup. A quantitative version compares different purchase designs: several, including the ECB's own with its deviations from market neutrality, deliver almost the same welfare gain, while concentrating purchases on a few large firms or directing them to the smallest eligible ones reduces it.

Work in Progress

Insuring Bank Loans: Capital Relief, Money Creation and Redistribution
(with Gabriela Araujo) [Draft]

We develop a general-equilibrium model of loan insurance and bank capital, emphasizing the wedge between the capital insurance releases and the risk it transfers. Priced at the loss it transfers, protection is bought for the capital relief. Because bank lending creates deposits, the price level moves with credit, and the real value of the wages workers hold as money moves against it. The model explains why euro-area banks insure loans whose capital charge is high relative to their risk and become riskier relative to their capital. Quantitatively, insurance barely moves credit or prices but thins bank capital, and a tighter requirement leaks into the insurance market. After a shock the size of the global financial crisis, the price of protection rises as bank capital becomes scarce. When banks cannot raise all the capital they need, lending contracts and the burden shifts from bank owners to workers, whose wages it finances.

Sovereign Spreads, Cross-Country Redistribution and Quantitative Easing in a Monetary Union (with Antonio Giribaldi and Iginio Marchesini Reggiani)

In a monetary union without a fiscal union, each government pays its own interest rate while its bonds are held across borders. Spread differentials that arise from financial frictions rather than default risk therefore redistribute resources between the households of different member states, a channel distinct from the level of interest rates. We document the interest flows that spread differentials generate across euro-area countries, using bilateral holdings imputed from the ECB's Securities Holdings Statistics. We then build a two-country New Keynesian model in which financial frictions generate these differentials. After a common financial shock, the spread of the more indebted country rises more, and resources flow from its households to those of the other country. Quantitative easing allocated by the capital key barely narrows the differential and leaves most of this redistribution in place; purchases targeted at the high-spread country close the differential and largely offset it.

Conferences and Seminars

2026 BSE PhD Jamboree; BSE Summer Forum (Financial Shocks, Channels and Macro Outcomes Workshop); International Ioannina Meeting on Applied Economics and Finance; SED Annual Meeting; EEA-ESEM Congress

2025 CREi Macro Lunch Seminar (Universitat Pompeu Fabra); Catalan Economic Society Congress; PhD Meetings in Economics; Madrid Mountain Macro Conference (poster); Naples School of Economics Workshop; Simposio de la Asociación Española de Economía

2024 CREi Macro Lunch Seminar (Universitat Pompeu Fabra); Imperial College PhD Conference in Economics and Finance; BSE PhD Jamboree

2023 CREi Macro Lunch Seminar (Universitat Pompeu Fabra)

Teaching Experience

Barcelona School of Economics – Graduate Courses

Teaching Assistant for:

"Advanced Macroeconomics III" (PhD track) 2023, 2024, 2025
Professors: Jordi Galí and Priit Jeenas

Universitat Pompeu Fabra – Undergraduate Courses

Teaching Assistant for:

"Macroeconomics I" 2022, 2023, 2024, 2025
Professors: Isaac Baley and Davide Debortoli

Research and Professional Experience

Research Assistant – Prof. Jan Eeckhout, Universitat Pompeu Fabra Oct 2026–Jul 2027

Research Assistant – Prof. Priit Jeenas, Barcelona School of Economics Nov 2021–Jul 2023

Additional Coursework

2024 Difference-in-Differences and Event Study Estimators with Panel Data (by Jeffrey Wooldridge) – EABCN

Awards and Scholarships

GPEFM PhD Track Fellowship, Universitat Pompeu Fabra	2021–2026
Dean Award for Achievement, The University of Manchester	2020
Stellify Award, The University of Manchester	2020
BA(Econ) Economics and other Social Sciences Second Year Prize, The University of Manchester	2019
Czeslaw Lejewski Logic Second Year Prize, The University of Manchester	2019
Gold Manchester Leadership Programme, The University of Manchester	2019

Languages and Technical Skills

Languages: Italian (native), English (fluent), Spanish (proficient), Catalan (basic)

Software and Programming: MATLAB (advanced), R (advanced), Stata (advanced), LaTeX (advanced), Julia (intermediate), Python (basic)